

Personal Policy for Use of Generative AI (GenAI) Online

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Artificial intelligence has increasingly become embedded in our technology and day to day lives. As an individual who regularly posts content to the internet, I believe it is important for me to disclose where I stand on AI, and how I use the technology when posting content.

I also want to make it clear that I am not inherently against all forms of AI. However, I also believe that there is a time and place for AI, and it should be used in an ethical, sustainable, and responsible manner. Some great examples of how AI has positively impacted society include medical fields, where AI is being used to detect early symptoms, which has the potential to save many lives. On the other hand, we must remain aware of the harms that AI can have on society. This includes water usage, taking jobs, and spreading misinformation.

I also want to make clear that the term 'AI' is broad, and its literal definition encompasses an enormous subset of computing technology. For the purposes of this document, I am specifically addressing Generative AI (GenAI), which is a subset of AI as a whole. This form of AI is quite controversial right now, and is also the form of AI most relevant to the content that I post on this platform.

Instagram Posts. Under most circumstances, I do not and will not use GenAI intentionally for regular content that I post to Instagram. This includes Instagram Posts, Stories, and Reels. My own content which does not use intentional GenAI include: photography posts, written commentary, and weather updates.

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Demonstrative AI Use. I occasionally demonstrate GenAI or other AI tools on Instagram. When I create content of this nature, it is usually posted to my Instagram Story. AI use will be declared with Instagram's built in 'Label AI' feature (as required by Instagram). I will also ensure that AI use is declared through a custom label as per this AI Use Policy.

Third Party Content. When posting/reposting content from third party authors, I may not always be able to verify whether or not GenAI was used. Where possible, I will refrain from posting third party content which is clearly generated with AI (unless it is demonstrative of the technology and would be cited as per this AI Use Policy).

Some creators regularly post local news/weather updates with AI on Facebook. I will typically avoid reposting these sources, and always aim to post the primary source. While this list is not exclusive (I do post content from other sources), the following are outlets/accounts that I regularly repost from:

- All Things Annapolis Valley
- CBC News
- CTV News
- Global News
- Nova Scotia Buzz
- Nova Scotia Fire/Emergency/Info
- Saltwire/PNI Atlantic News
- Spencer Ferguson Nova-Scotia Weather
- The Laker News
- The Weather Network
- Truro & Colchester Code 1 Coverage
- Weather (Apple)
- Local FM Radio Stations

*This list intentionally does not list any academic or government departments. Posts by these institutions are exempt from my GenAI Use Policy. Official press releases from a business are also considered exempt. These posts, however, will still be labelled as per this AI Use Policy.

Third Party Content (Continued). If you have any issues with third party content reposted on my account (e.g., unethical use of AI, inaccurate information), PLEASE reach out to me ASAP via direct message. This allows me to address potential misinformation and/or ensure that AI content is declared appropriately.

Image Processing/Editing. GenAI tools will NEVER intentionally be used to alter photography posts in my feed. For the purpose of my policy, any alterations made to a photo between pressing the shutter button and it appearing in my camera roll is considered “unintentional”. The one exception is if a device has a toggle for GenAI image processing (which would then be considered intentional). Portrait Mode, Night Mode, Photographic Styles, and on-device background removal will NOT be considered GenAI. Photo reframing tools (iOS 27) would be considered AI and would be declared appropriately.

Basic editing tools may be used to provide minor touch ups to a photo. This includes using an airbrush to remove a spec of dust from the lens, or using red eye remover tools. Any edits will be done on device (if possible) and will be done only to eliminate unintended blemishes to the photo. Minor edits will usually not be declared.

Written Content. All articles written on my blog (blog.benjaminmacleod.com) are written by me. Before I post a blog article, I use spell check (which may use AI on their backend). I do not change how I write to avoid “sounding like AI” (yes, I do sometimes use an em dash!), and I do not use paraphrasing software (Quillbot).

Despite my best efforts, I am human, and I do make mistakes! If you catch something, please send me a direct message so I can get it sorted ASAP!

Web Content. I have a basic understanding of HTML and CSS. Where possible, I try to manage my own website and blog's codebase. I do use AI to help me with JavaScript, which does magical things to my website that I am not quite smart enough to figure out on my own! I also sometimes use AI to debug, as it seems to do this quite well. For clarity, I did not just ask AI to "Generate me a website".

I want to make it clear that I have spent many, many hours at my keyboard working on my website. I made the decision to use AI as a tool so I could continue to write HTML/CSS (something I enjoy) without getting burnt out of the project. AI provided me the ability to write some of my own code instead of using Google Sites, which is not as customizable.

I continue to try and build my coding skills (one day I would love to learn JS and not need AI to help), and I regularly use W3Schools to teach myself concepts. As a university student, however, this is not a priority of mine and is set on my project 'backburner'.

Content Labelling. All content created or reposted by me will feature an AI label if AI was intentionally used during the content's creation.

<i>AI Assisted</i>	Content that was created by a human but used AI during the creative process to modify a portion of the content (e.g., using ChatGPT for topic generation, using Claude for generating a code snippet). It is usually difficult to identify work that was 'AI Assisted'.
<i>AI Modified</i>	Content that was created by a human but used AI after the work was created to modify the content (e.g., using Gemini to remove the background from a photo).
<i>AI Generated</i>	Content that was generated entirely or mostly with the use of AI software (e.g., using Gemini to create a Deepfake video, using Meta AI to publish an AI generated poster).
<i>AI</i>	Content which uses AI but is unclear which label is appropriate for the content. Where possible, one of the above AI labels will be applied instead of this label.

Content Labelling (Continued).

AI Assisted

AI Modified

AI Generated

AI

The above content labels shall be used by Benjamin MacLeod for identifying AI.

Disclaimer: As of August 2026, there are no laws governing AI declaration for the region this account is based in (Nova Scotia, Canada). Should an AI Use Policy be introduced in the region that is stricter than this policy, respective law(s) will supercede this policy and this document will be updated accordingly.

Conclusion/TLDR

- I do not use AI for my own content on Instagram, unless the content's purpose is demonstrative.
- Where possible, I avoid posting third party GenAI content unless the content's purpose is demonstrative.
- All posts (by me or by a third party) known to have used GenAI will be declared in a clear and transparent manner.
- Images may contain minor touch ups, so long as it is done on-device and does not alter the original context.
- Written content is always written by me, but spell check is used to check for glaring errors.
- Some of the code (mostly JavaScript) on my website was generated with AI, but I spent hours writing HTML and CSS to ensure the site matches my personal brand.
- If you have an issue with the accuracy/transparency of my content, reach out!

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